

different aspects – a field so large that you'd need to be an expert before getting further into it.

Artificial Intelligence and Creativity

The human mind is a complex mechanism – a kind of super computer that manages to combine knowledge and reasoning to tackle gargantuan problems in a jiffy. And yet, understanding these aspects of the brain has helped scientists come to a point where they feel confident of claiming that at some point, a computer will be able to carry out these functions. But intelligence has one more factor whose inclusion throws the world of artificial intelligence into a tizzy: Creativity.

What is creativity?

Creativity would have been a tricky thing to explain if we weren't all born with it. The ability to think of something new, or applying old formulae in a new way, separates the mind of the human from any other animal.

Of course, this is a simplistic explanation of an extremely complex matter. Think about it this way: if we didn't have the ability to be creative, would we intrinsically know what is creative and what isn't? Take writing, for instance. The ability to write fiction is often considered a creative output. The same can be said about art – a field that is most often associated with creativity. However, if an artist is replicating a scene he saw somewhere, then is it still creative? And if a writer is creating a new way of expressing an old idea, is it still creative? It's incredibly difficult to define creativity in a universal manner because the term holds different meanings for each human.

For the sake of this write-up, however, let's treat creativity the way one of the foremost thinkers on the subject, Margaret Boden, defines it: "Creativity is the ability to come up with ideas or artefacts that are new, surprising, and valuable. "Ideas", here, includes concepts, poems, musical compositions, scientific theories, cooking recipes, choreography, jokes ... and so on, and on. "Artefacts" include paintings, sculpture, steam-engines, vacuum cleaners, pottery, origami, penny-whistles ... and you can name many more."

Why is creativity important in thinking?

Taking the very base meaning of being original, creativity is still a large and complex issue. But its need in the thought process cannot be understated.